

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Problem Statement:

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

User Story:

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

Project Objective:

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

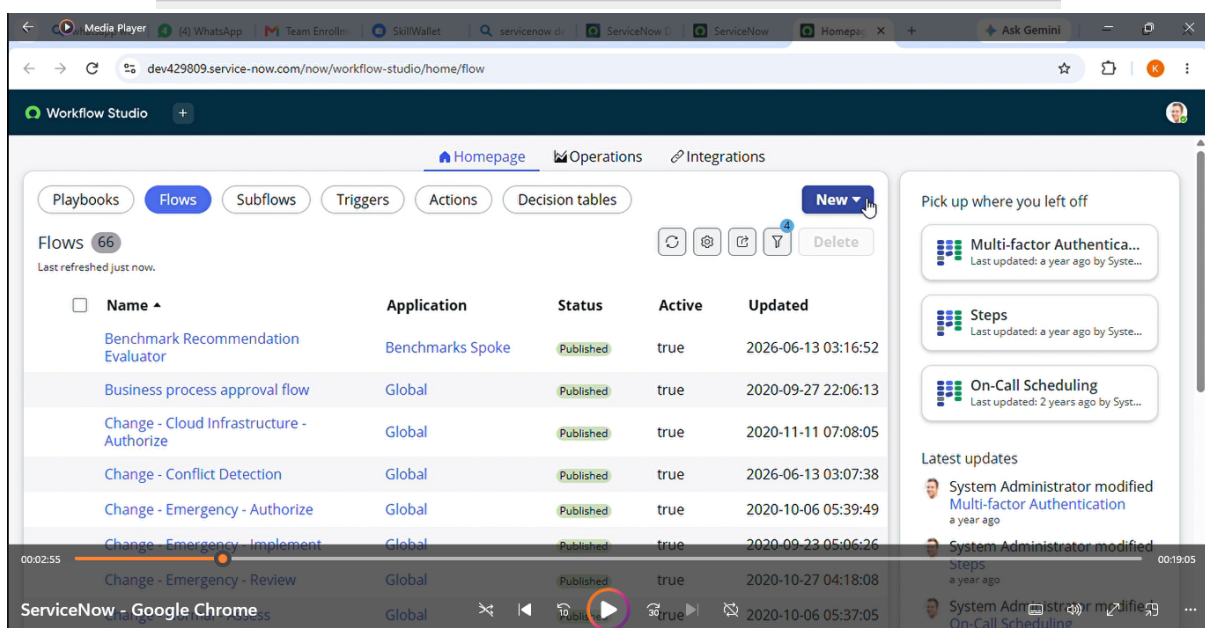
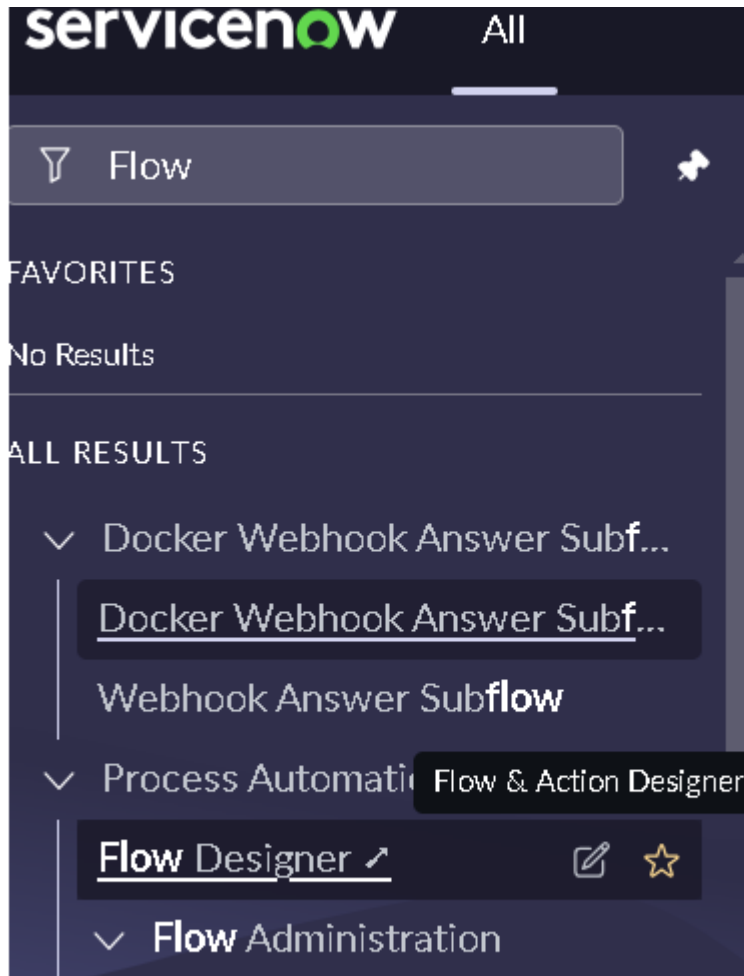
1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

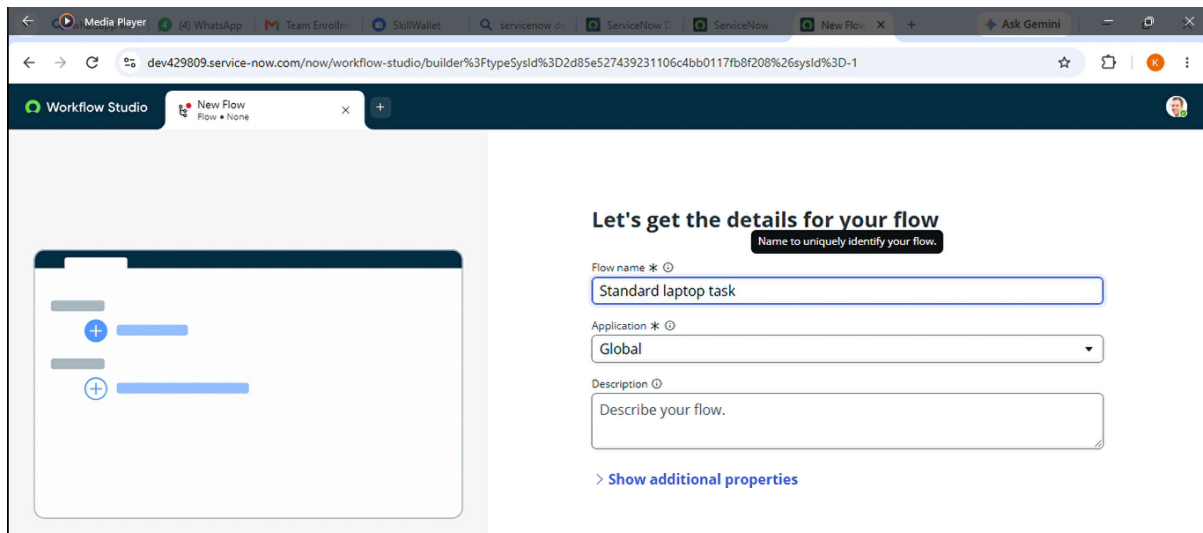
TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Flow

Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware. Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.





Let's get the details for your flow
Name to uniquely identify your flow.

Flow name *

Application *

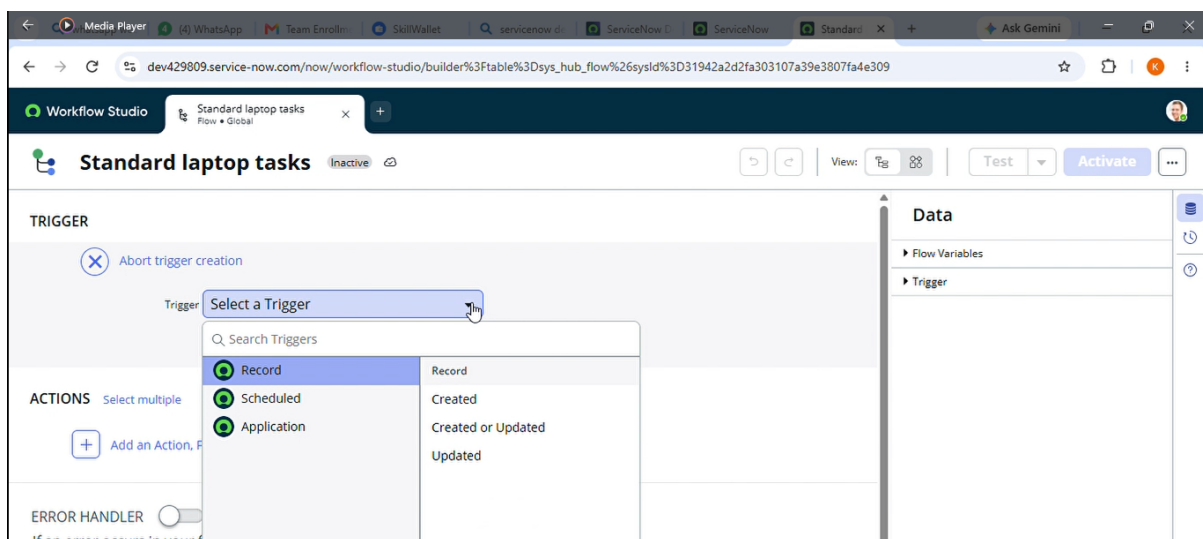
Description

[Show additional properties](#)

9. Click on Add a trigger

10. Select the trigger in that Search for “ Service Catalog ” and select that.

11. After that click on Done.



Standard laptop tasks Inactive

TRIGGER

Abort trigger creation

Trigger

Search Triggers

- Record
- Scheduled
- Application

ACTIONS Select multiple

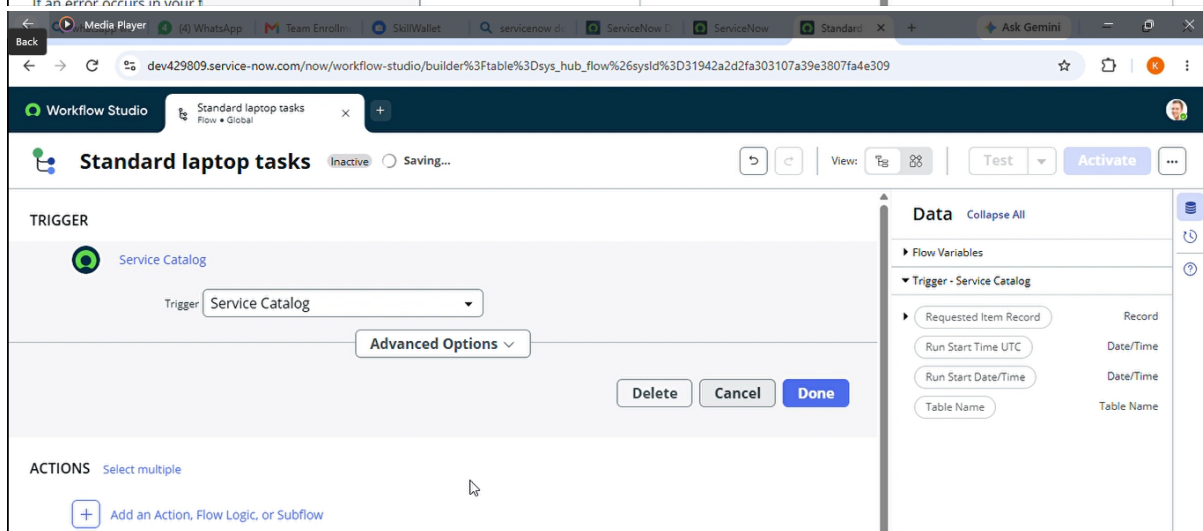
Add an Action, Flow Logic, or Subflow

ERROR HANDLER

If an error occurs in your flow

Data

- Flow Variables
- Trigger



Standard laptop tasks Inactive Saving...

TRIGGER

Service Catalog

Trigger

Advanced Options

Delete Cancel Done

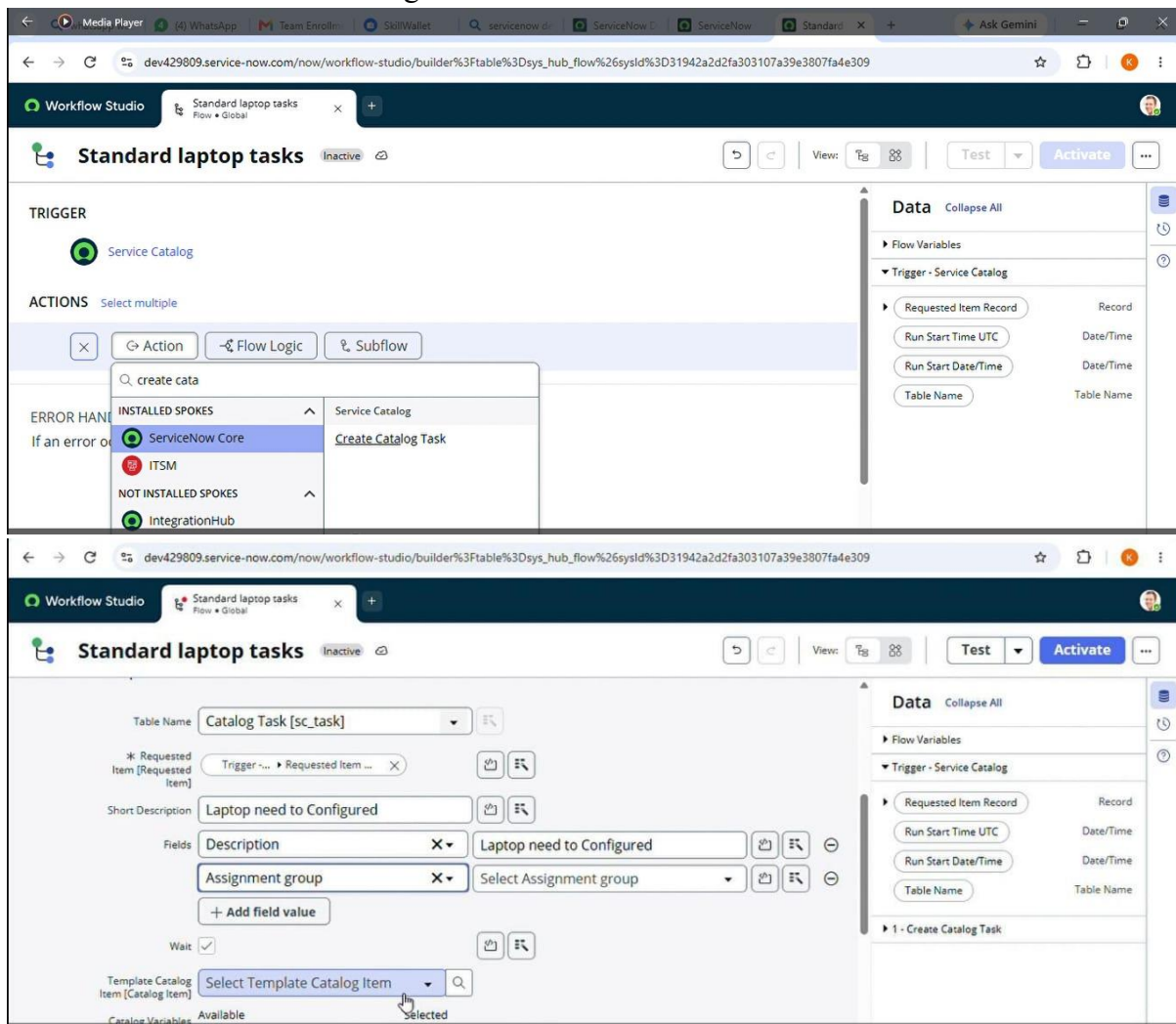
ACTIONS Select multiple

Add an Action, Flow Logic, or Subflow

Data Collapse All

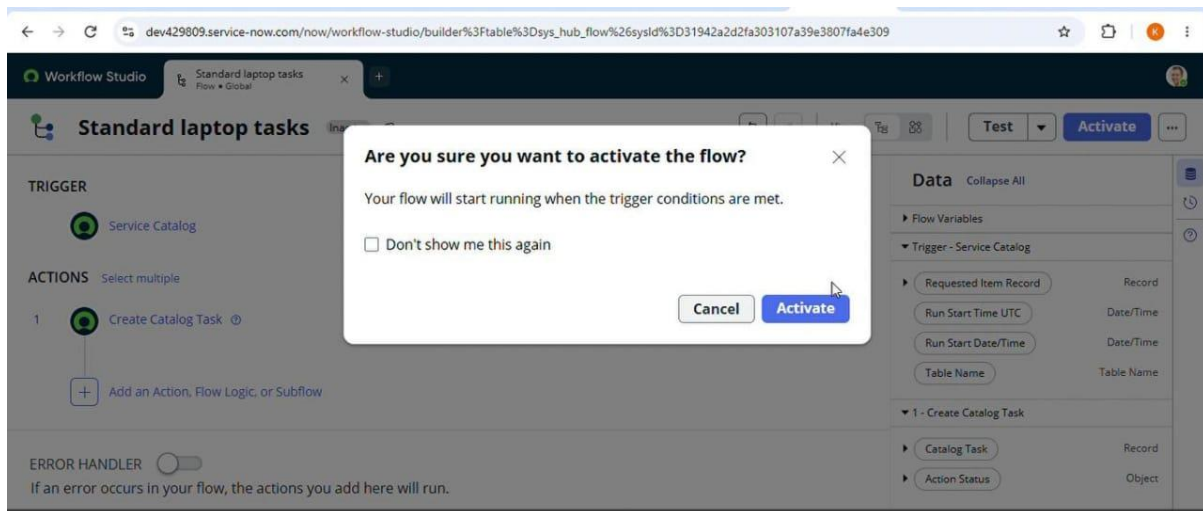
- Flow Variables
- Trigger - Service Catalog
- Requested Item Record
- Run Start Time UTC
- Run Start Date/Time
- Table Name

12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
22. Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
23. Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
25. Click on save the Flow.
26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.



The top screenshot shows the 'Standard laptop tasks' flow in the Workflow Studio. The 'TRIGGER' is set to 'Service Catalog'. The 'ACTIONS' section shows a search for 'create cata' with 'Create Catalog Task' selected under 'ServiceNow Core'. The 'Data' panel on the right shows the 'Requested Item Record' with fields like 'Run Start Time UTC', 'Run Start Date/Time', and 'Table Name'.

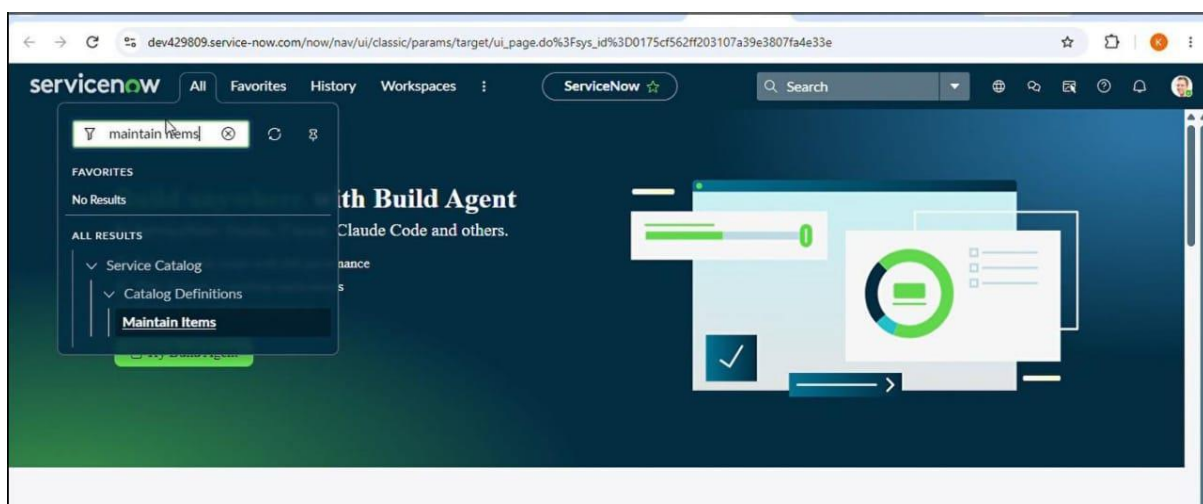
The bottom screenshot shows the configuration details for the 'Create Catalog Task' action. The 'Table Name' is 'Catalog Task [sc_task]'. The 'Requested Item' is 'Trigger -> Requested Item ...'. The 'Short Description' is 'Laptop need to Configured'. The 'Fields' section shows 'Description' and 'Assignment group' with values 'Laptop need to Configured' and 'Select Assignment group' respectively. The 'Wait' checkbox is checked. The 'Template Catalog Item' dropdown is set to 'Select Template Catalog Item'.

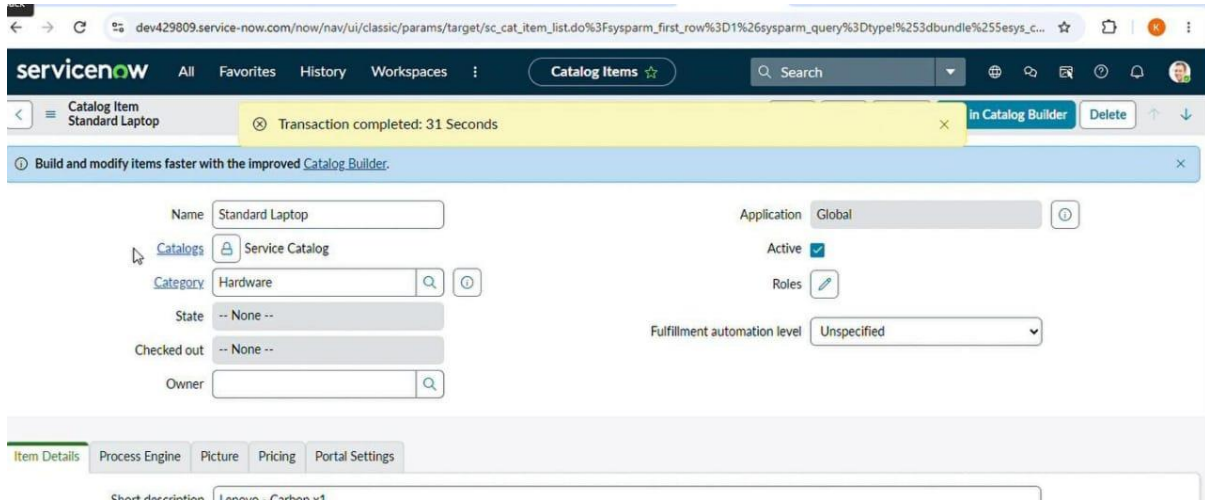


Milestone 2 : Flow assignment Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog. Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name " Standard Laptop Task".
8. Click on the menu to save the record.





dev429809.service-now.com/now/nav/ui/classic/params/target/sc_cat_item_list.do%3Fsysparm_first_row%3D1%26sysparm_query%3Dtype!%253Dbundle%255esys_c...

servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces Catalog Items Search

Catalog Item: Standard Laptop Transaction completed: 31 Seconds in Catalog Builder Delete

Build and modify items faster with the improved Catalog Builder.

Name: Standard Laptop Application: Global

Catalogs: Service Catalog Active: ☒

Category: Hardware Roles:

State: -- None -- Fulfillment automation level: Unspecified

Checked out: -- None --

Owner:

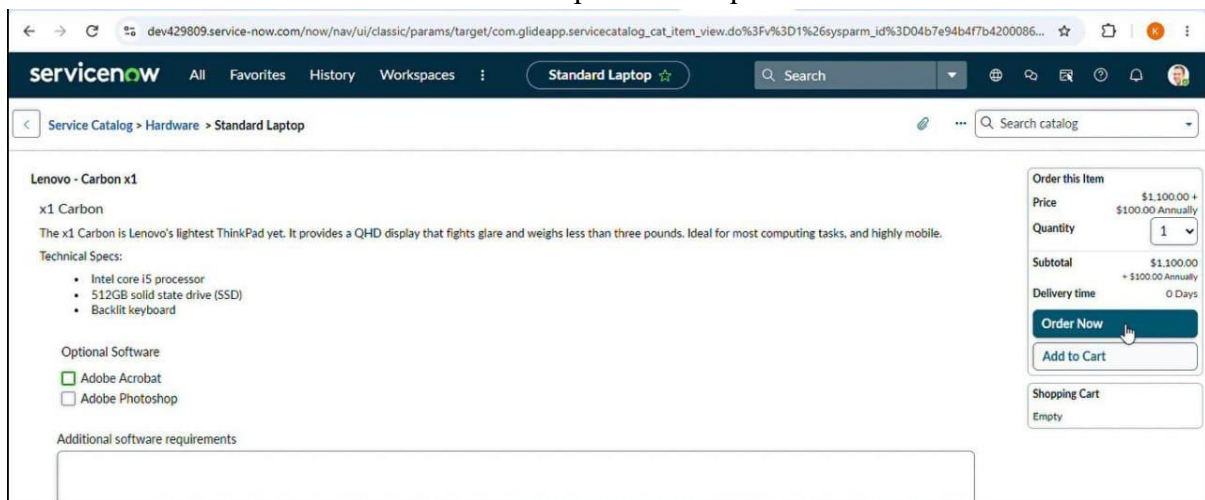
Item Details Process Engine Picture Pricing Portal Settings

Short description: Lenovo - Carbon x1

Milestone 3 : Service Catalog Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
4. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.



dev429809.service-now.com/now/nav/ui/classic/params/target/com.glideapp.servicecatalog_cat_item_view.do%3F%3D1%26sysparm_id%3D04b7e94b4f7b4200086...

servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces Standard Laptop Search

Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop Search catalog

Lenovo - Carbon x1

x1 Carbon

The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.

Technical Specs:

- Intel core i5 processor
- 512GB solid state drive (SSD)
- Backlit keyboard

Optional Software

☒ Adobe Acrobat

☐ Adobe Photoshop

Additional software requirements

Order this Item

Price: \$1,100.00 + \$100.00 Annually

Quantity: 1

Subtotal: \$1,100.00 + \$100.00 Annually

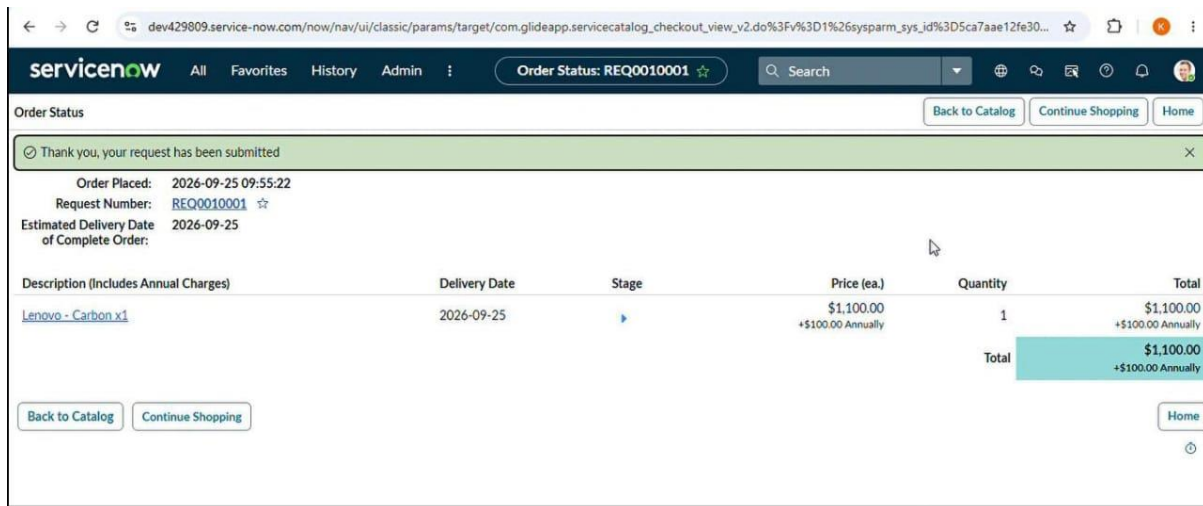
Delivery time: 0 Days

Order Now

Add to Cart

Shopping Cart: Empty

5. Now we will see the Order status
6. In that click on the Request Number

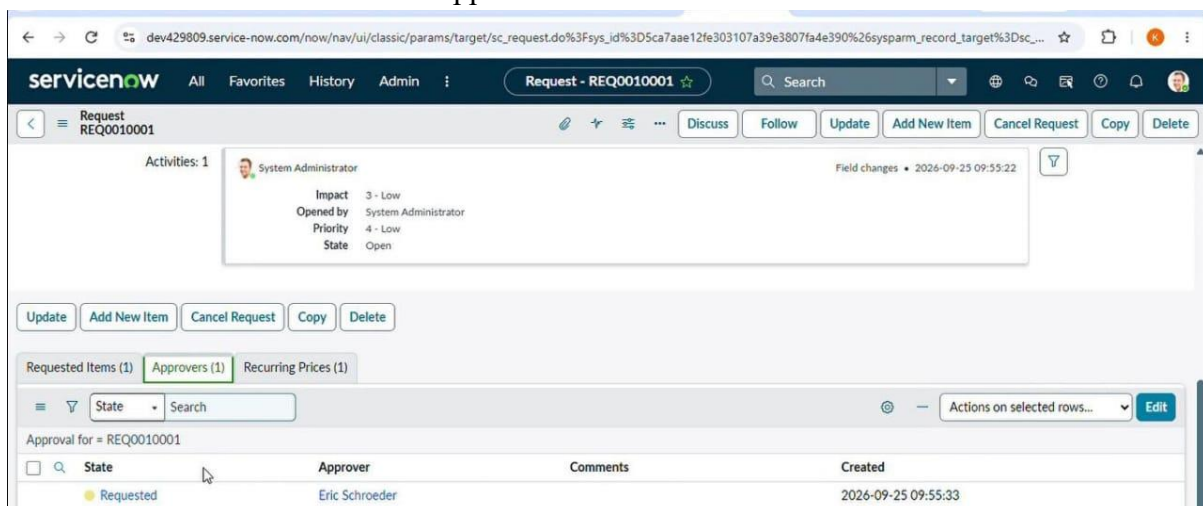


The screenshot shows the ServiceNow 'Order Status' page for request REQ0010001. A green notification bar at the top states 'Thank you, your request has been submitted'. Below this, the order details are listed: Order Placed: 2026-09-25 09:55:22, Request Number: REQ0010001, and Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order: 2026-09-25. A table displays the order items:

Description (Includes Annual Charges)	Delivery Date	Stage	Price (ea.)	Quantity	Total
Lenovo - Carbon x1	2026-09-25		\$1,100.00 +\$100.00 Annually	1	\$1,100.00 +\$100.00 Annually
Total					\$1,100.00 +\$100.00 Annually

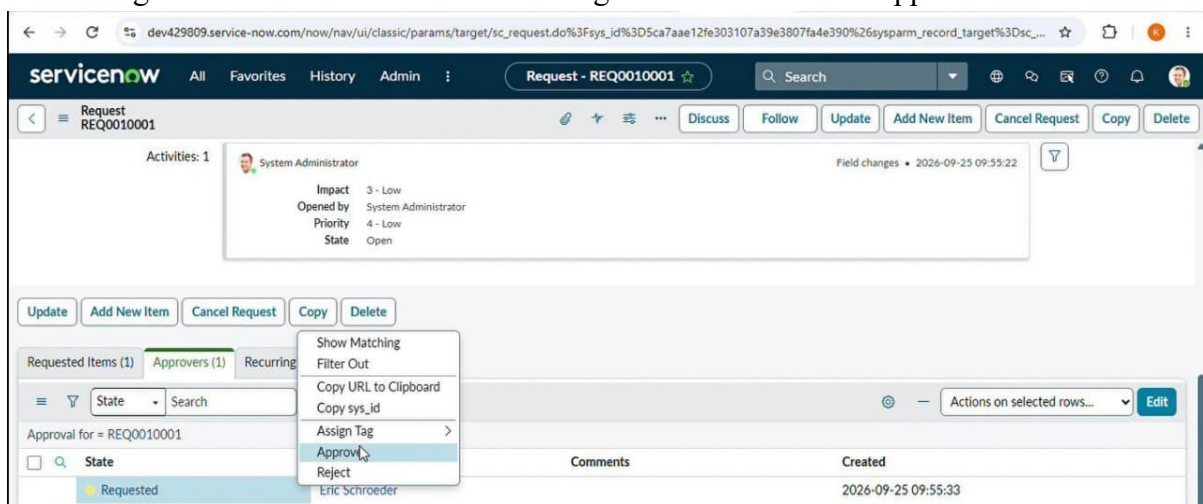
Buttons for 'Back to Catalog', 'Continue Shopping', and 'Home' are visible at the bottom.

7. It will open the Requested number record.
8. Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.



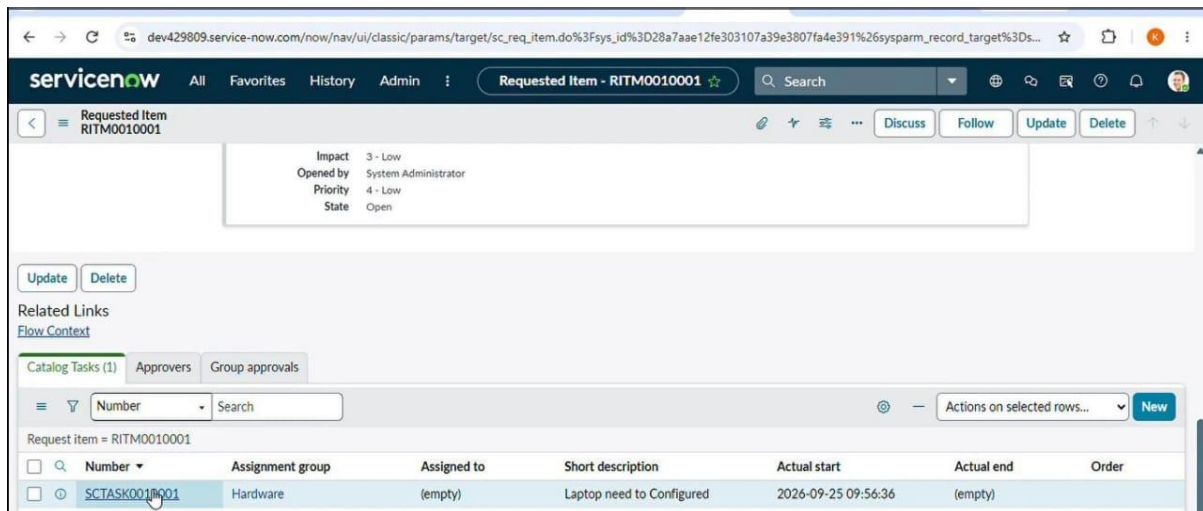
The screenshot shows the 'Request - REQ0010001' page. The 'Activities' section shows the request was opened by the System Administrator. Below this, the 'Requested Items (1)' tab is active, showing a table with one item in a 'Requested' state, approved by Eric Schroeder on 2026-09-25 09:55:33. The 'Approvers (1)' tab is also visible.

9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.



This screenshot shows the same 'Request - REQ0010001' page, but with a right-click context menu open over the 'Requested' item. The menu options include 'Show Matching', 'Filter Out', 'Copy URL to Clipboard', 'Copy sys_id', 'Assign Tag', 'Approve', 'Reject', and 'Delete'. The 'Approve' option is highlighted.

10. Then click on the Requested item Section
11. Open that Requested Item record



dev429809.service-now.com/now/nav/ui/classic/params/target/sc_req_item.do%3Fsys_id%3D28a7aae12fe303107a39e3807fa4e391%26sysparm_record_target%3Ds...

servicenow All Favorites History Admin : Requested Item - RITM0010001

Requested Item
RITM0010001

Impact 3 - Low
Opened by System Administrator
Priority 4 - Low
State Open

Update Delete

Related Links
[Flow Context](#)

Catalog Tasks (1) Approvers Group approvals

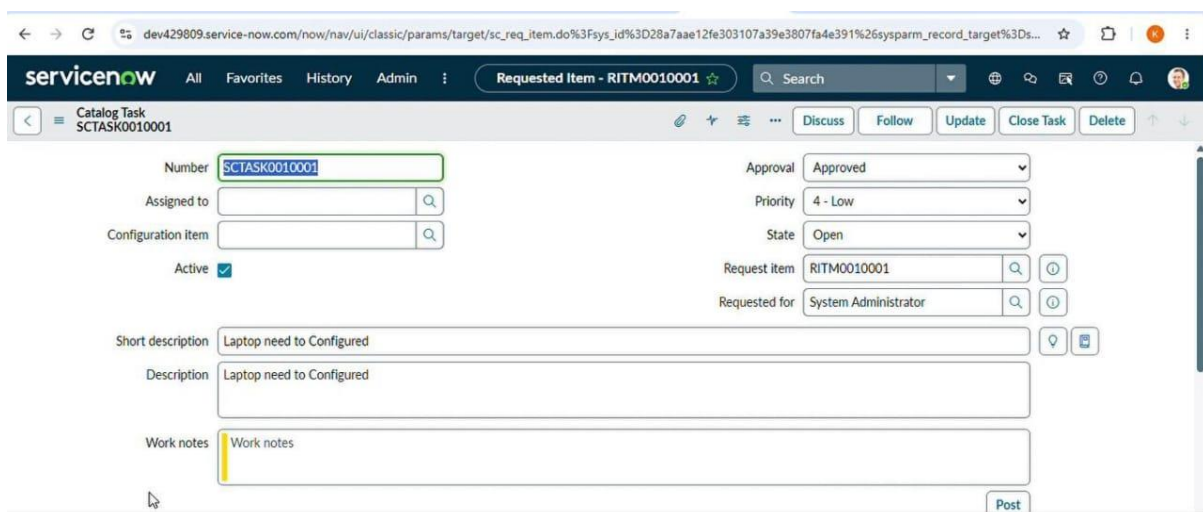
Number Search Actions on selected rows... New

Request item = RITM0010001

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop need to Configured	2026-09-25 09:56:36	(empty)	

12. Scroll down to the “Catalog tasks” Section

13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.



dev429809.service-now.com/now/nav/ui/classic/params/target/sc_req_item.do%3Fsys_id%3D28a7aae12fe303107a39e3807fa4e391%26sysparm_record_target%3Ds...

servicenow All Favorites History Admin : Requested Item - RITM0010001

Catalog Task
SCTASK0010001

Number Approval Approved

Assigned to Priority 4 - Low

Configuration item State Open

Active ☒ Request item Requested for

Short description

Description

Work notes

Post

Conclusion : Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.

